Sowing and Reaping

Because God is never mocked, every believer's use of time, money and resources — starting with support of those who teach — is seed that will yield either decay or lasting reward, so we keep sowing to the Spirit without growing weary.

Where this study fits

Galatians · sixteen studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5 The Ground of Liberty	**02** 1:6–10 The One True Gospel	**03** 1:11–17 Paul's Independent Revelation	**04** 1:18–2:10 Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches
05 2:11–21 Peter Goes Back to School	**06** 3:1–5 Under a Spell	**07** 3:6–14 Blessing or a Curse	**08** 3:15–29 The Superiority of the Promise to the Law
09 4:1–11 When I Became a Man	**10** 4:12–20 A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove	**11** 4:21–31 Paul's Old Testament Story	**12** 5:1–12 Taking a Stand in Liberty
13 5:13–26 Walk in the Spirit	**14** 6:1–5 Brothers and Burdens	**15** 6:6–10 Sowing and Reaping	**16** 6:11–18 Teaching the Truth

Sowing and reaping in four parts

Galatians 6:6–10 · The commentary's outline

I **The Performance · v.6**

Share all good things with the one who teaches you

II **The Principles · vv.7–8**

God is not mocked: four laws of the harvest

III **The Pledge · v.9**

A harvest in due season — if we do not lose heart

IV **The Priority · v.10**

Do good to all — especially the household of faith

“Share in all good things with him who teaches”

Galatians 6:6 · Outline I — The performance

The command — v.6

κατηχούμενος · κοινωνείτω taught · share

- Those taught the word share with the one who teaches
- An ongoing responsibility

Why it seemed strange

1. **The law**
   The temple system was already funded
2. **The Judaizers**
   They discouraged support of grace teachers
3. **Paul's own example**
   He waived his right (1 Cor 9) — his choice, not a rule

None of the three changed the believers' responsibility.

Four laws of the harvest

Galatians 6:7–8 · Outline II — The principles

1 We reap if we sow

Put in before you take out — “unless a grain of wheat falls into the ground and dies” (John 12:24)

2 We reap what we sow

Sow to the flesh → corruption (φθοράν); sow to the Spirit → everlasting life

3 We reap more than we sow

One kernel planted yields a full ear and more

4 We reap later than we sow

The farmer plants, waits, and harvests in its time

“Do not be deceived, God is not mocked” — μυκτηρίζεται: to turn up one's nose at Him.

“Will of the Spirit reap everlasting life”

Galatians 6:8 · The posted study's Free Grace reading

	The gift of eternal life	Reaping everlasting life (v.8)
Received by	Faith alone in Christ alone	Sowing to the Spirit — faithful living
When	The moment a person believes	In due season — at the harvest
Can it be lost?	Never	It can be forfeited by sowing to the flesh
What it is	Life itself — a free gift	Reward: ruling with Christ (cf. 5:21; 2 Tim 2:12)

Paul is writing to believers who already have eternal life. The harvest in view is reward.

Don't grow weary — and start at home

Galatians 6:9–10 · Outline III–IV — The pledge and the priority

v.9a	“Let us not grow weary while doing good”	**ἐγκακῶμεν** lose courage
v.9b	“for in due season we shall reap”	**καιρῷ ἰδίῳ** God's right time
v.9c	“if we do not lose heart”	**ἐκλυόμενοι** a runner giving out
v.10	“Do good to all, especially to those who are of the household of faith”	**οἰκείους** first, not only

Keep doing what the Lord has led you to do — until He leads you to do something else.

Discuss and apply

Galatians 6:6–10 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is one thing in your life that is clearly “sowing to the flesh,” and what would sowing to the Spirit look like in that same area?

2. Where have you been tempted to grow weary in doing good because you haven't yet seen a harvest?

Apply

Sow Into Your Teachers

Take one concrete step this week — financial or otherwise — to support someone who faithfully teaches you the word.

Don't Lose Heart

Recommit to a work for one more defined season, and ask someone to check in with you on it.

In one line: God is not mocked: keep sowing to the Spirit, and in due season you will reap.